nomination of judges and various laws that would limit the independence of the judiciary in the future. Apart from their immediate political aim, the supporters of the reform aim at changing the supposedly “old boy” method of Ashkenazi judges “adopting” Ashkenazi colleagues to the court, to the exclusion of any “Moroccan” justice.

Some supporters of the judicial legislation also give the US as an example of a democracy in which justices are politically nominated. This is forgetting that the US Supreme Court takes its decisions within a highly elaborate constitution which the court can interpret but not amend.

At 1:00 a.m., the coalition voted in a first reading in favor of two main pieces of legislation. The Knesset majority within the judicial selection committee will be able to control the appointment of Supreme Court judges, and the Supreme Court will henceforth not be allowed to amend any of the Basic Laws (in Israel, a series of Basic Laws, unlike “ regular” laws, deal with the individual liberties of its citizens as they were outlined in Israel’s Declaration of Independence).

Ben-Gvir threatens: if his office does not receive the supplementary budget he is asking for in order to appoint additional police personnel, raise police salaries, and set up a national guard, he will leave the government. If only he could keep his word for once!

Some four years ago Avi Maoz’s ultrareligious Noam, which is part of the government (albeit a tiny one) established a confidential list of fifty gay personalities whom it accuses of undue influence in media and entertainment. A journalist just revealed its existence. Maoz has been given a position in the Ministry of Education, but Netanyahu promised that the status of the LGBTQ community would not change. Let us see. In any case, the religious parties suddenly besiege the country from all sides.

The latest joke making the rounds: don’t forget to set your clock back 2,000 years.